MANATOBI / ORIGINAL PRACTICE

英検2級
リーディングトレーニング

第14回 問題冊子

リスニング・英作文を含まない部分練習 ／ 全31問

大問	問題番号	内容
1	1〜17	短文の語句空所補充
2	18〜23	長文の語句空所補充
3	24〜31	読解

使い方

・解答用紙に答えを記入してください。問題冊子には正答を載せていません。
・問題・解説はA4縦、解答用紙はA4横。白黒・片面・実際のサイズ（100%）で印刷します。
・解き終わるまでは、別冊の解答・解説を開かないでください。
・同じ問題をアプリの分野別練習でも解けます。

独自作成した英検2級形式のリーディング第14回です。リスニング・英作文・面接は含みません。公式教材ではなく、CSE・合否換算はしません。筆記全体の公式時間をリーディングだけの時間に流用しません。外部難度校正は未実施です。

氏名：＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿＿

1

短文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

(1) To prevent newly planted street trees from toppling in autumn typhoons, arborists ( ) each trunk to three wooden stakes.

1 secure **2** scatter **3** scribble **4** surrender

(2) Although the island bakery bakes only four kinds of sourdough loaves, weekend visitors line up ( ) before the shutters open at seven.

1 eerie **2** equally **3** eagerly **4** erratically

(3) Because glacier-fed river water carries fine rock flour, hydroelectric turbines require tough coatings capable of ( ) constant abrasion.

1 withdrawing **2** withstanding **3** withholding **4** witnessing

(4) The botanical conservatory kept its orchid room misted every hour ( ) an unseasonably dry winter wind.

1 in the event of **2** in the wake of **3** in contrast to **4** in response to

(5) After grease buildup triggered a smoke alarm in the cafeteria, the school principal had every range hood exhaust duct ( ) over spring break.

1 degreased **2** decreased **3** degraded **4** disguised

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

(6) Marine insurers remain (　　) of autonomous cargo vessels operating in crowded straits without a human watch officer aboard.

1 weary　**2** wary　**3** worthy　**4** wealthy

(7) Standardizing charger plugs across tablet brands brought welcome (　　) to travelers tired of packing tangles of cables.

1 severity　**2** scarcity　**3** simplicity　**4** secrecy

(8) Not until the medieval chapel roof was scanned with infrared cameras (　　) conservators spot rainwater seeping behind oak beams.

1 have　**2** had　**3** were　**4** did

(9) Because fresh chestnuts lose sweetness rapidly at room temperature, orchardists chill harvested nuts right away so starch may turn to sugar without (　　).

1 spinning　**2** spilling　**3** spoiling　**4** sparking

(10) When winter storms washed out the wooden footbridge, park rangers (　　) a temporary rope-and-plank crossing downstream.

1 erected　**2** erased　**3** erupted　**4** evaded

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(11) Although the municipal pool stayed closed for two months during boiler replacement, membership renewals bounced back (　　) once warm lanes reopened.

1 bleakly　**2** briskly　**3** blindly　**4** bluntly

(12) Unventilated basements carved into volcanic rock can accumulate odorless radon gas at levels (　　) to human lungs.

1 harmonious　**2** humorous　**3** hospitable　**4** hazardous

(13) To (　　) confusion between similarly named heart tablets, hospital pharmacies print key syllables in bold capital letters.

1 curb　**2** coax　**3** cram　**4** cling

(14) Before signing a two-year apartment lease, newcomers are wise to look (　　) hidden monthly fees for bicycle parking and hallway maintenance.

1 after　**2** down　**3** over　**4** into

(15) When three violinists caught influenza the night before the winter gala, alumni musicians stepped (　　) to fill the empty chairs.

1 out　**2** off　**3** in　**4** aside

1　短文の語句空所補充（続き）

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(16) Every firefighter helmet carries a reflective number strip so commanders can identify crew members at a (　　) through thick smoke.

1 glare　**2** glance　**3** glimpse　**4** glow

(17) Rather than haul pruned apple branches to an incinerator, the orchard chips them into mulch to (　　) moisture around young tree roots.

1 retain　**2** retire　**3** retort　**4** retract

2

長文の語句空所補充
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Why Stadiums Leave Wind Gaps Under Their Roofs

Watch an evening soccer match inside a modern European or Japanese stadium, and you will notice a dramatic architectural frame: a sweeping roof shelters almost every spectator seat from rain, yet stops abruptly around a wide open oculus above the grass pitch—while slotted gaps also pierce the lower wall behind corner flags. Fans sometimes wish builders had sealed the bowl completely against cold wind, yet turf agronomists insist those carefully modeled air vents keep natural grass alive.

Championship soccer requires resilient living grass whose roots knit sandy soil together when players pivot at full sprint. Semi-enclosed stadium roofs, however, cast deep midday shadows across the southern touchline and trap humid air exhaled by fifty thousand spectators. Without steady breeze skimming across the blades, morning dew and irrigation water linger all day, inviting fungal turf diseases that can rot an entire penalty box within forty-eight hours. (18), stagnant air starves grass leaves of fresh carbon dioxide during sunny hours.

Wind-tunnel engineers therefore test scale stadium models with smoke streams before steel fabrication begins. Low wall louvers draw cool street-level air across the pitch and vent warm moist air upward through the roof opening by natural convection. On calm winter weeks when clouds block sunlight too, groundskeepers wheel out mobile LED grow-light rigs and low-noise turf fans to supplement nature. (19), sensors buried beneath the center circle monitor root-zone moisture and salt buildup hour by hour.

What looks like an unfinished gap between wall and roof actually reflects how modern stadium design (20).

(18)

1 On the contrary
2 Otherwise
3 Worse still
4 Instead

(19)

1 In vain
2 Meanwhile
3 Conversely
4 Previously

(20)

1 replaces living grass with painted green concrete
2 eliminates the need for groundskeepers to water the field
3 keeps rain clouds away from cities during championship matches
4 treats spectator comfort and living turf health as one connected system

Why Libraries Digitize Local Ephemera

When people picture historical treasures preserved in library vaults, they usually imagine leather-bound diaries of prime ministers, medieval maps, or first-edition novels. Yet social historians trying to reconstruct how ordinary families shopped, commuted, and celebrated eighty years ago often find grand official books frustratingly silent. Increasingly, municipal libraries are scanning fragile everyday paper—"ephemera" never meant to survive more than a week—such as tram tickets, neighborhood festival handbills, department-store lunch menus, and rationing coupons.

Printed on cheap acidic wood-pulp paper, ephemera yellows and crumbles far faster than rag-paper books if left in attic shoeboxes. Once digitized with high-resolution overhead cameras and tagged by street name and year, however, a single box of 1950s grocery flyers unlocks vivid economic history: researchers can compare seasonal sardine prices against factory wages, trace when electric rice cookers entered working-class kitchens, or spot vanished cinema names along a suburban shopping arcade. (21), retired residents invited to library "scan-and-share" Saturdays often supply the spoken context behind a faded ticket stub before memories fade.

Curating everyday paper still demands selective judgment. Libraries lack server space and staff hours to scan fifty identical bus timetables from the same month, so archivists sample representative items across diverse districts rather than only wealthy downtown streets. (22), privacy rules require redacting personal medical receipts or living individuals' home addresses before posting scans online.

Fragile handbills and menus may look disposable, yet preserving them gives future generations (23).

(21)

1 Better still
2 Otherwise
3 On the contrary
4 In vain

(22)

1 For instance
2 At the same time
3 Instead
4 Previously

(23)

1 a reason to throw away all leather-bound historical diaries
2 unlimited storage for fifty identical copies of every bus schedule
3 an unfiltered window into how ordinary communities actually lived
4 permission to publish private medical records without consent

3 長文の内容一致選択
1〜4から最も適切な答えを一つ選び、解答用紙にマークしてください。

Guidelines for Borrowing Roof-Snow Measurement Kits

From: Kitano Town Winter Safety Division
To: Neighborhood Association Snow Wardens
Subject: Calibrating borrowed snow-core tubes before December patrols

Dear Snow Wardens,
Thank you for volunteering to monitor roof-snow loads on elderly residents' homes this winter. Measuring snow depth with a ruler alone can be dangerously misleading: forty centimeters of fluffy January powder weighs far less than forty centimeters of rain-soaked February pack, which can quietly overload older timber rafters.

Starting Monday, each district warden may pick up a lightweight aluminum snow-core tube and hanging spring scale at Town Hall Annex Room 104. Push the hollow tube straight down to the roof eaves marker, lift out a vertical cylinder of snow, and weigh it on the hook scale to read water-equivalent load in kilograms per square meter.

Before every morning patrol, hang the empty dry tube on the scale and turn the top brass ring until the pointer reads exactly zero; trapped ice inside the barrel will inflate readings. Please log figures on the shared tablet form by noon.

Winter Safety Division

Guidelines for Borrowing Roof-Snow Measurement Kits — Questions

(24) Why is measuring snow depth with a ruler alone insufficient for judging roof safety?

1 Snow rulers shrink by half whenever temperatures drop below zero.

2 Rain melts aluminum rulers within five minutes.

3 Timber roofs collapse under even two centimeters of January powder.

4 Equal depths of fluffy powder and rain-soaked snow differ greatly in actual weight on roof rafters.

(25) How must wardens calibrate the spring scale before each morning patrol?

1 Leave the scale buried in a snowbank overnight.

2 Fill the aluminum tube with warm tap water and weigh it.

3 Hang the empty dry tube on the scale and turn the brass ring until the pointer reads zero.

4 Mail the spring scale back to the manufacturer every Tuesday.

(26) What could cause the snow-core kit to give artificially high weight readings?

1 Ice left stuck inside the hollow tube from an earlier measurement.

2 Using the scale on sunny mornings.

3 Recording numbers before noon on the tablet.

4 Standing on the south side of Town Hall Annex.

How Geothermal Heat Pumps Tap Steady Ground Warmth

Ask homeowners in snowy Hokkaido or northern Europe how they heat rooms in January without burning kerosene or natural gas, and a growing number point downward rather than toward the sky. While winter air temperatures swing wildly between mild afternoons and minus-fifteen-degree nights, soil and rock just ten to fifty meters beneath the frost line stay at a remarkably steady ten to fifteen degrees Celsius all year round—insulated by the earth itself like a giant subterranean thermos.

Ground-source (or geothermal) heat pumps exploit that quiet thermal stability without needing volcanic hot springs. Contractors drill narrow vertical boreholes beside a house or school and lower sealed plastic U-tubes filled with water and nontoxic antifreeze. In winter, circulating fluid absorbs modest warmth from the surrounding earth and carries it indoors, where an electric compressor concentrates that heat to warm floor pipes or radiators. Because moving existing warmth takes far less electricity than generating heat from scratch with resistance coils, a well-designed ground loop delivers roughly four units of indoor heat for every single unit of electrical energy consumed.

Better still, the cycle reverses effortlessly in July. Instead of struggling to dump indoor heat into thirty-five-degree street air the way ordinary outdoor air-conditioner units must, a ground-source pump sends surplus room heat down into cool twelve-degree earth—trimming summer cooling bills while gently recharging soil warmth for the coming winter.

Why, then, has ground-source heating not replaced every furnace overnight? Drilling fifty-meter boreholes requires specialized rigs that struggle to enter cramped urban alleys, and upfront installation can cost two to three times as much as an air-source heat pump, taking a decade of lower utility bills to pay back.

To hurdle that barrier, several municipalities and housing developers now build shared neighborhood ground loops beneath parks or parking lots, letting individual households hook into steady underground warmth for a predictable monthly fee.

How Geothermal Heat Pumps Tap Steady Ground Warmth — Questions

(27) What physical property of soil ten to fifty meters underground makes ground-source heat pumps effective?

1 It boils at one hundred degrees even outside volcanic zones.

2 Its temperature stays steady around ten to fifteen degrees all year despite surface weather swings.

3 It freezes solid every October and melts in June.

4 It generates natural gas pockets beneath every suburban lawn.

(28) Why does a ground-source heat pump use much less electricity than an electric resistance heater?

1 It burns underground coal seams to spin a steam turbine.

2 Homeowners pump antifreeze by hand every morning.

3 It heats rooms only above twenty degrees in spring.

4 Moving and concentrating existing ground warmth requires far less electrical energy than creating heat from scratch.

(29) How does the underground loop benefit a building during hot July weather?

1 It transfers indoor heat down into cool twelve-degree earth more efficiently than dumping heat into hot outside air.

2 It sprays cold mud over rooftop solar panels.

3 It shuts off completely until snow returns in December.

4 It freezes bedroom windows shut to block humidity.

(30) What main obstacle has slowed widespread adoption of individual ground-source systems?

1 Antifreeze tubes dissolve in soil after two winters.

2 Electricity use rises fourfold compared with resistance coils.

3 Ground loops stop working whenever snow covers the roof.

4 Drilling boreholes requires heavy rigs and high upfront costs that take years to recover.

How Geothermal Heat Pumps Tap Steady Ground Warmth — Questions (continued)

(31) How are some municipalities and developers helping households overcome high installation costs?

1 By banning air conditioners across northern cities.

2 By asking families to dig fifty-meter boreholes with garden shovels.

3 By building shared neighborhood ground loops under parks or parking lots with monthly connection fees.

4 By pumping volcanic steam through wooden rain gutters.